closer ties with Nepal and also ensuring internal stability in Nepal.

In her bid to have a strong Nepal, India had played a central role in abolishing Rana oligarchy in Nepal and restoration of Monarchy and gradual working towards Parliamentary democracy. Under the auspices of India, a tripartite negotiation was held among King Tribhuban, Nepali Prime Minister Mohan Shamsher Janga Bahadur Rana and the then Indian Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru in February, 1951. All through, the anti-Rana movement, India made it clear that the primary objective of India is to make Nepal, independent, progressive and strong. Further, from the 1960–1990 political parties were banned in Nepal, but parties like Nepali Congress, Communist Party of Nepal and other parties operated from India. India always wanted a strong and democratic Nepal to act as a bulwark against Chinese designs. Under the Primeministership of B.P. Koirala, the Nepali Congress formed the government after the elections in 1958. However, this government was short-lived and was brought to an abrupt end by the 'Royal Coup' in December 1960. King Mahendra assumed direct and absolute control of the state.

With the assumption of Mahendra of complete state power, Nepal gradually tried to assert itself independent of Indian directions. He tried to cultivate relations with China quite against the provisions of the 1950 Treaty. Sino-Indian conflict of 1962 made Nepal and China come closer. The Chinese even proclaimed to provide help to Nepal if it were attacked. They also signed with Nepal an agreement to construct a road to link Kathmandu with the Chinese border. Thereafter, King Birendra who succeeded King Mahendra, even raised a plea to declare Nepal as a 'Zone of Peace'. India looked at this as a violation/dilution of the 1950 Treaty. Nepal tried to develop relations with Pakistan too which was reciprocated by Pakistan. Even a trade agreement was signed between both in 1962, whereby Pakistan extended port facilities to Nepal through Chittagong. Another transit agreement was also signed with Pakistan. However, during the India-Pakistan war of 1965, Nepal maintained a neutral stance and emphasized on the re-establishment of friendly relations between India and Pakistan. India also tried to mend fence with Nepal around this time. Nepal had to do a tight rope walking while